

Reading

Schools Around the World

Before you read

- What type of school do you attend?
- What other types of schools have you heard of?

Schools around the world look very different from one another. In many countries, most students attend public schools, which are usually free and open to everyone in the local area. Public schools often follow a national curriculum set by the government, so students in the same country study similar subjects at the same age.

Some families choose a different path. Boarding schools, for example, are places where students live during the school term instead of going home every day. Students at boarding schools eat, study, and often do extracurricular activities together, which can create a strong sense of community. Other students attend vocational schools, where the curriculum focuses on practical skills for a future job, such as mechanics, cooking, or design.

A smaller number of families choose homeschooling, in which children study at home instead of going to a school building. Parents or private tutors usually manage the curriculum, and the timetable can be more flexible than in a traditional school. Whatever the type of school, most students share similar experiences: friendships, exams, and unforgettable memories from their school years.

1. According to the text, public schools usually follow...
 - a. a curriculum chosen by each student
 - b. a national curriculum set by the government
 - c. no curriculum at all
 - d. a curriculum from another country
2. Students at boarding schools go home every evening. — *True / False*
3. What is the main focus of a vocational school's curriculum?
 - a. Academic theory only
 - b. Practical skills for a future job
 - c. Sports and games
 - d. Foreign languages only
4. In homeschooling, _____ or private tutors usually manage the curriculum.
5. What do most students share, according to the last paragraph?
 - a. The same uniform
 - b. Friendships, exams, and memories
 - c. The same school building
 - d. The same timetable

After you read

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 10. Sınıf — Reading · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

- Which type of school described in the text would you prefer to attend, and why?
- Do you think homeschooling has any disadvantages? Discuss.

Dealing with School Stress

Before you read

- Do you ever feel stressed about school? When?
- What do you usually do to relax?

Feeling stressed about school is extremely common, especially before exams or big deadlines. Many students report feeling overwhelmed by their workload, worried about test results, or anxious about speaking in front of the class. This kind of stress is a normal part of student life, but it becomes a problem when it starts to affect sleep, appetite, or motivation.

Fortunately, there are simple strategies that can help students cope with school stress. Planning ahead and breaking large tasks into smaller steps can make a heavy workload feel more manageable. Regular exercise, even a short walk after school, can also reduce tension and improve concentration. Talking to a friend, family member, or teacher about how you feel is another effective way to cope, because it stops worries from building up inside.

Teachers and schools also have a role to play. Some schools now offer quiet rooms where students can relax between lessons, or organise workshops about time management. When students learn to recognise the signs of stress early and use these strategies, school can feel less like a source of anxiety and more like a place to learn and grow.

1. According to the text, when does stress become a problem?
 - a. When it never happens
 - b. When it affects sleep, appetite, or motivation
 - c. When students study too little
 - d. When exams are cancelled
2. Breaking large tasks into _____ steps can reduce stress.
3. The text suggests that talking about your feelings can help reduce stress. — *True / False*
4. What example of a school strategy is given in the text?
 - a. Longer school days
 - b. Quiet rooms for relaxing
 - c. More homework
 - d. Fewer exams
5. What is the writer's main purpose in this text?
 - a. To criticise schools
 - b. To explain school stress and offer coping strategies
 - c. To describe an exam
 - d. To compare two countries

After you read

- Which strategy from the text do you think would help you most? Why?

- Can you suggest another way to cope with school stress that isn't mentioned in the text?